

Interview Written Report

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Name, title, and company of the person interviewed.

For the interview I chose Wendy Showalter. Wendy is a Chief Financial Officer (CFO) with extensive experience in her specific industry. She works for two different companies: East Coast Lumber and Industrial Wood Products. Her job is very diverse allows and involves a lot of different aspects. I was excited to learn more about her career and insights into the financial and accounting profession.

A description of the individual's organization in terms of its products and/or services delivered, and its competitors.

The companies that Wendy works for offers an extensive range of products and services related to wood and lumber. Their operations include everything from buying, selling, trading, remanufacturing, and importing wood products. While they specialize in industrial applications that require Southern Yellow Pine, they also excel in sourcing a variety of hardwoods, high-grade pine, truss materials, and specialty trims. In addition, the company provides valuable services such as cutting lumber to precise lengths, adding grooves for easier installation, and creating patterns on lumber.

A description of the educational and employment background of the person interviewed, how long they have been in their current position, how long they have been with the organization, and how they 'fit' within the organization.

Wendy graduated from High Point University in 1996, she has a bachelor's in accounting. Before becoming the CFO for where she works now, she was a pharmacy tech as well as having worked in the restaurant industry. Before her job that she has now she hadn't worked any job that was similar to what she does now. Wendy has been in her current position at the companies

where she is now for 29 years, she fits into her organization because she is super organized and keeps the company in a good standing where she has control.

A description of the individual's specific job responsibilities.

Wendy is responsible for a range of critical financial tasks within her company, including overseeing the preparation of financial statements and managing budgets. She plays a key role in monitoring financial receivables and payables, ensuring that all transactions are handled efficiently and accurately. Additionally, she serves as the primary liaison with the bank, navigating financial relationships and addressing any banking needs that arise. Her expertise in these areas is essential to maintaining the company's financial health and stability.

What the individual feels has been their greatest success within their current position.

Wendy's work consistently yields accurate results, which is particularly evident during the yearly audits she conducts. Her reliability is a key factor in why these audits are less frequent. Her attention to detail ensures that her records are always organized and correct. Wendy maintains thorough backups of all her work, further solidifying her reputation for dependability. This level of organization not only makes the auditing process a lot easier but also instills confidence in her colleagues and superiors. She also sees her ability to do research on topics she isn't sure about as a strength of hers.

What the individual feels has been their greatest challenge within their current position, and what lesson they learned from this challenge.

Wendy mentioned that people often assume that she knows everything there is to know about various topics, such as taxes and the regulations in the multiple states she works with.

However, she emphasizes that this is not the case as she frequently conducts extensive research and asks questions to gain clarity on unfamiliar issues. She believes it's important to acknowledge when you don't have all the answers and to embrace the opportunity to learn through research, while it may be difficult at times it is also necessary, this demonstrates that continuous growth and understanding are vital in her role.

What the individual anticipates is the long-term outlook for their chosen career and challenges to someone just entering the profession.

Wendy believes that her job is here to stay, as it relies heavily on the human component and the trustworthiness of individuals in the profession. She recognizes that every industry and company bring its own unique challenges, meaning that even within the same profession, no two experiences are identical. Wendy emphasizes that you won't know everything right away and that learning is an ongoing process that occurs in real-world settings, which can be quite different from what is taught in school. She encourages others to ask plenty of questions, highlighting that curiosity and a willingness to learn are essential for success in any role.

Your reflection on the interviewee's position and their industry and whether you see yourself within that position and industry.

Reflecting on the interview with Wendy, I gained valuable insights into her position as a CFO. I find myself drawn to the dynamic nature of her role, as well as the emphasis on trust and human connection in the industry. While I recognize that I would need to develop my knowledge and skills further, I see the potential for growth in a similar position.